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temporarily before they are sent out through the cloaca. Fertilization is external.

Within few days of fertilization, the **eggs** hatch into **tadpoles**. A newly hatched tadpole lives off the yolk stored in its body. It gradually grows larger and develops three pairs of gills. The tadpole grows and **metamorphosis** into an air – breathing carnivorous adult frog (Figure 4.25). Legs grow from the body, and the tail and gills disappear. The mouth broadens, developing teeth and jaws, and the lungs become functional.

Economic importance of Frog

- Frog is an important animal in the **food chain**; it helps to maintain our ecosystem. So '**frogs should be protected'.**
- Frog are beneficial to man, since they feed on insects and helps in reducing insect pest population.
- Frogs are used in traditional medicine for controlling **blood pressure** and for its **anti aging** properties.
- In USA, Japan, China and North East of India, frogs are **consumed** as delicious food as they have high nutritive value.

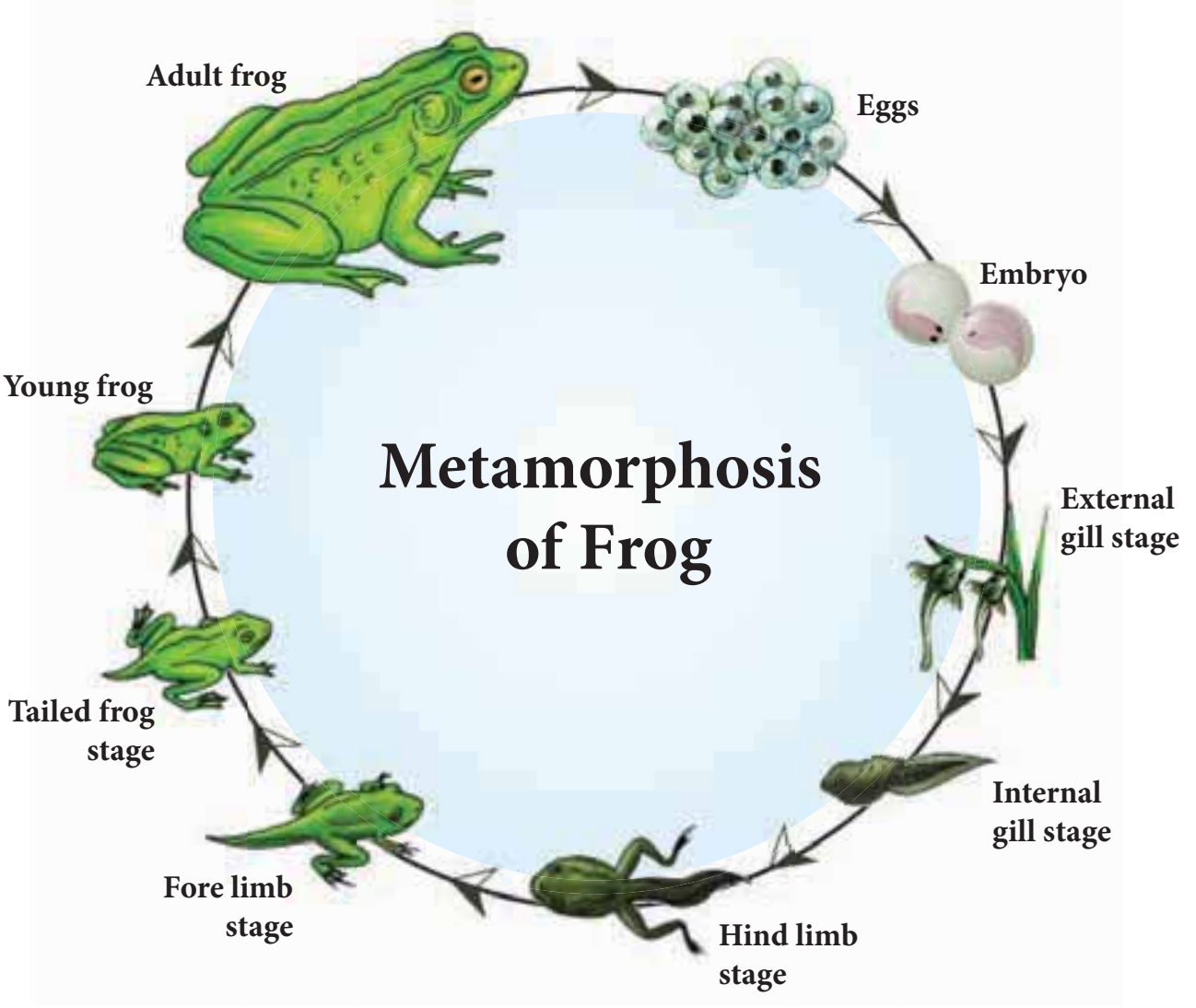


Figure 4.25 *Rana hexadactyla* - Metamorphosis